Negative Double

Partner opens 1 of a suit and the next opponent overcalls a suit:
Double by you is not for penalty - it says you **would** have responded if no overcall.
You need 6+ points for 1-level double, more for higher level double
Negative Double promises at least four cards in any unbid Major
If both Majors have been bid, double promises both minors
1♣/♦ - 1♥ - dbl - promises 4-card Spade suit
1♣/♦ - 1♥ - 1♠ - promises 5+ card Spade suit

Support Cue-bid

When partner opens and next player overcalls, a Cue-bid by you shows Limit-raise or better support for partner's suit. Any raise of partner's suit is preemptive and shows LESS than a Limit-raise.

When an opponent opens, partner overcalls, and the next opponent passes, a Cue-bid by you shows Limit-raise or better support for partner's suit. Any raise of partner's suit is preemptive and shows LESS than a Limit-raise.

Board: 1
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 2♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥Q

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♣5

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 1NT
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥4

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2♠
Declarer: West
Lead: ♦Q

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣J

Board 1
West Deals
None Vul

	♠ A K 9 7 3 ♥ 6 5 4 ♦ Q 3 ♣ 7 6 3	
♠ 5 4 ♥ 8 7 2 ♦ A K 10 5 2 ♣ K Q 10		♠ J 10 ♥ Q J 10 ♦ J 8 6 4 ♣ J 9 5 4
	♠ Q 8 6 2 ♥ A K 9 3 ♦ 9 7 ♣ A 8 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♦	1♠	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠		
All Pass			

2♠ by North
Lead: ♥Q

Compare this to Deal 10.

SOUTH has the strength for a raise to game in ♠s, but this could be dangerous since NORTH has overcalled rather than opened. Instead, SOUTH shows her strength with a Support Cue-bid.

NORTH has very minimal overcall so he just bids 2♠ which SOUTH passes.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ A J 10 9 6 ♥ 5 4 ♦ 5 3 ♣ J 9 4 3	
♠ Q 7 5 ♥ Q J 9 3 ♦ A 10 8 2 ♣ Q 8		♠ 8 ♥ A K 10 8 7 ♦ K Q J 4 ♣ A K 6
	♠ K 4 3 2 ♥ 6 2 ♦ 9 7 6 ♣ 10 7 5 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	1♠
2♠	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♦[2]	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♥ by East
Lead: ♣5

EAST has a maximum 1♥ opening bid.

WEST would have made a Limit Raise in ♥s, but after SOUTH's overcall she makes a Support Cue-bid instead.

EAST thinks there may be a slam and bids 4NT Blackwood to check for Aces. When WEST admits to one Ace EAST bids the slam.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 6 2 ♥ A Q J 3 ♦ J 8 4 ♣ J 9 8 2	
♠ A 10 9 4 ♥ 6 4 2 ♦ 10 5 3 ♣ K 5 3	N W E S	♠ 8 5 3 ♥ K 9 8 5 ♦ K Q 2 ♣ Q 7 6
	♠ K Q J 7 ♥ 10 7 ♦ A 9 7 6 ♣ A 10 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
1♠	Dbl	Pass	1NT
All Pass			

1NT by South
Lead: ♥4

NORTH has 9 points a a ♥ suit - good enough to make a Negative Double over WEST's 1♠ overcall.

But SOUTH doesn't have ♥s, she has ♠s and ♦s, so she bids 1NT to show her ♠ stopper and a minimum opener.

NORTH should pass.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

♠ 8 5 3
♥ A 6 5 4
♦ Q J 2
♣ 7 6 3

♠ A K 6 4 2
♥ 9 3
♦ 10 9 7
♣ 9 8 2



♠ Q 9 7
♥ J 8 7
♦ A K 8 6
♣ K 10 4

♠ J 10
♥ K Q 10 2
♦ 5 4 3
♣ A Q J 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♦	1♥
1♠	Pass	2♠	
All Pass			

2♠ by West
Lead: ♦Q

With five ♠s WEST bids the suit rather than making a negative double.

EAST knows this shows a 5-card suit so he can support with only three ♠s.

WEST doesn't have anything extra so she passes 2♠.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A J 7
♥ K 9 8 7
♦ K Q 7 6
♣ 5 4

♠ Q 8 4
♥ 6 4
♦ J 10 9 5
♣ K Q 9 3



♠ 10 5 3
♥ J 10 2
♦ A 3 2
♣ J 10 8 7

♠ K 9 6 2
♥ A Q 5 3
♦ 8 4
♣ A 6 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♦	2♣	Dbl
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♣J

SOUTH has both Majors and planned on bidding 1♥ first, (up-the-line). After EAST's overcall, SOUTH makes a Negative Double, showing both Majors and at least 10 points to make a 2-level Negative Double.

NORTH bids 2♥, showing a 4-card suit and minimum opening hand. Notice that this is not a Reverse by NORTH, showing extra strength. She is not really bidding ♥s on her own, she is supporting partner's suit.

SOUTH has 13 points so he bids 4♥.